

point in that 10-dimensional space. The coordinates of each point are determined by the fraction of each card value remaining in the deck.

What was the strategy you eventually developed?

When I first wrote a paper on this for the proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, I described a fives strategy, but that was because it was simple and everyone would get it. But it wasn't the strategy I planned to use or did use. In the fives strategy, if all the fives are out, you have a 3.3 percent edge. A simple application would be to bet with the basic strategy 90 percent of the time and make really big bets 10 percent of the time when all the fives are out. That was a good strategy in the sense that no one expected this feature of the game. Everyone thought that the aces and 10s were the important thing. The problem with the strategy was that decks with all the fives out occurred only about 10 percent of the time. The next strategy I developed was based on 10s. My reasoning was that since there are a lot of 10s in the deck, a 10s-based strategy would provide considerably more fluctuation in the odds.

Is the idea that even though the fives strategy provides a higher probability bet, the 10s strategy provides far more opportunities?

Exactly. Fives were actually the card that had the most influence. Aces were next, and then 10s and 6s.

Did you have trouble getting your paper published given the gambling subject matter?

Here is how I got it published. I knew I had to get into print fast because there were unscrupulous people around who would claim they had discovered the same information. I had been through several rounds in my career where people had stolen things that I had written in the math world and claimed it was theirs. I decided I wanted to get quick publication, and I wanted to get it into a prestigious journal. The best way to do that was to get it published in the National Academy of Sciences, but you had to find a member who would submit the paper for you or else they wouldn't take it. I researched the Cambridge area where I was located and found that there were two members. One member was an algebraist at Harvard who wouldn't have any idea what I was talking about and probably wouldn't have cared if he did. The other member was